

Microtek Flatvision 38FI a slight shift was visible at the edge of the bands. The same was the case with the HP 55 and Sony CPD E100.

In the 19-inch category, white-and black-level shift was visible in the Samsung 900NF whereas the white level shift was visible in the HP P920 and LG 995E. In the 21-inch category, ViewSonic G810 showed a slight white-level shift at the edge of the bands, but nothing of the sort was visible in LG StudioWorks 221U.

The monitors were even tested for colour purity in terms of the red, green and blue primaries. In this test, we found that red was difficult to produce—it tended to be brighter in the middle and darker at the corners. Blue and green were produced on the screen with near perfection in most of the monitors. Among the 19-inch monitors, the Compaq MV940 gave good results with no irregularities anywhere on the screen.



The Sony CPD-E100 was the only 15-inch monitor with an Aperture Grille CRT

In the 15-inch category, Acer V551, Philips 105E and Sony CPD E100 all returned good results with the screen perfect throughout in all the three colour purity tests.

In the 21-inch category, ViewSonic G810 gave unsatisfactory results in the red colour purity test with a pink tinge visible at the lower left corner of the monitor and this appeared more prominent on this monitor because of the large viewable area.

Miscellaneous effects: Screen uniformity is an important consideration, especially if you are transferring images from a scanner or a digital camera. Slight

changes in colour and you end up thinking of it as a scanning or transfer problem, while the real culprit could be the monitor.

In the 19-inch category, only two monitors, Compaq MV940 and HP P920, passed this test successfully. The remaining either had a colour tinge in the corner or were bright in the middle or in the corners. The 15-inch monitors were not very different in this respect, and only the Compaq MV540 had a uniform screen followed by the Philips 105E that had a uniform screen but for the green line visible at the right edge of the monitor. However, in the 21-inch range, both the monitors fared above average, though the ViewSonic G810 was a little brighter in the middle than in the corners and LG StudioWorks 221U had a prominent blue tinge in the lower right corner.

For 21-inch monitors, it is essential to have perfect screen uniformity because of the large viewable area—any colour tinge or variation is more prominent in these monitors.

The monitors were also tested for flicker and most monitors passed this test at the standard 75 Hz refresh rate. However, the Acer 99SL 19-inch monitor had a lot of flicker even at 75 Hz, which can strain your eyes.

In the 15-inch category, the Comptech CT535 OSD had lots of flicker, which was especially prominent in the white colour. The Krypton V500 was also not flicker-free at 75 Hz, flicker being more visible in light colours than in the dark colours.

One problem that we came across in the dark screen test was that in monitors such as the Compaq MV940 and MV540, Krypton V500 and LG StudioWorks 563N, background objects were clearly visible, which means if you are using an application such as 3D imaging software where the background is mostly black, you will have to adjust the seating arrangement time and again to get rid of the background object which otherwise will give rise to a lot of problems while viewing the drawing on the screen and the small font.

Features

What is the maximum resolution you get, or the actual viewing area? Questions such as these may very well mark your buying decision.

Horizontal and vertical scan rate: Horizontal scan rate is always mentioned in terms of a range, say between 30-98 KHz. This is the number of times the horizontal

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